

Student Guide — primary / module-08-yoga

IKS Curriculum

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Student Workbook

My Yoga Book — Primary

My name: _____ **Class:** _____

Day 1 — Mountain (tāḍāsana)

I stood like a mountain for ____ seconds.

How did my feet feel? _____

Day 2 — Tree (vṛkṣāsana)

How many times did I wobble? _____

(Wobble = learning!)

Easier side: _____

Day 3 — Child's Pose (balāsana)

I rested for ____ seconds.

After the pose, my body felt: _____

Day 4 — Cat-Cow

I did ____ cat-cow waves.

Did I make the moo / meow sound? [Yes / No]

Day 5 — Bumblebee Breath (bhrāmarī)

How long was my longest hum? _____ seconds

How did my head feel after? _____

Day 6 — The Animal Walk

I did _____ rounds.

My favourite pose in the flow: _____

Day 7 — Invent a Pose

The pose I invented:

Name: _____

Draw it:

What it stretches or strengthens: _____

Days 8–9 — My Project

Final pose name: _____

Who I practised teaching to: _____

What feedback I got: _____

Day 10 — I Taught the Class!

★ Sticker

The class trying my pose looked like: _____

Glossary

Word	What it means
yoga	to join (body, breath, mind)
āsana	pose / posture
prāṇa	breath / life energy
tāḍāsana	mountain pose
vṛkṣāsana	tree pose
balāsana	child's pose
mārjārī / bīdalāsana	cat / cow
bhrāmarī	bumblebee breath
namaste	I bow to you

Day 1 — What is Yoga? (The Mountain)

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children meet yoga through a story and stand in *tāḍāsana* (mountain pose).

Materials

- Mats / floor space
- A picture of a mountain

The flow

Settle (3 min)

Sit on mat, hands on knees. 5 natural breaths.

Story (5 min)

*“Yoga is a very old practice from India. It uses our bodies, our breath, and our mind — all together. The Sanskrit word **yoga** means ‘to join.’ We join body, breath, and mind.”*

*“Today our pose is **tāḍāsana** — mountain pose. We stand still and tall, like a mountain.”*

Tāḍāsana practice (12 min)

- Show the picture of a mountain. “What’s a mountain like?” (Tall. Strong. Still.)
- “Now *BE* a mountain.”
- Stand at top of mat. Feet hip-width.
- “Press your feet into the ground like roots.”
- “Stand *TALL*. Pretend a string is gently pulling the top of your head up.”

- “Take 3 deep breaths. Breathe like a calm mountain.”

Hold for 30 sec. Release. Repeat 3 times.

Between rounds, ask: - “Did anyone feel taller?” - “Did your feet feel heavier or lighter?”

Reflection (5 min)

- “Why might mountains be the first pose we learn?” (Steady. Strong. Doesn’t move.)
- “You’re a mountain. You can come back to mountain anytime you need to feel steady.”

Close (5 min)

Tāḍāsana one more time. Then sit. Hands together at heart. “Namaste” — “I bow to you.”

Homework

- Stand like a mountain for 30 seconds before brushing your teeth tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Hold for 60 seconds. Add “soft eyes looking ahead.”
- **Tier down:** Hold for 15 seconds. Lean on a wall if needed.

Teacher’s quick notes

- This is the foundational pose for the whole module. Use it to open and close every class.
- Some children will fidget. Allow gentle sway — mountains in nature aren’t perfectly still either.

Day 2 — The Tree (vṛkṣāsana)

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children try the tree pose. Wobble is welcome.

Materials

- Mats
- Picture of a tree (and a flamingo)

The flow

Settle + opening tāḍāsana (3 min)

5 breaths, then 30 sec mountain pose.

Story (5 min)

*“Today’s pose is **vrkṣāsana** — tree pose. A tree stands tall on one root. Today YOU’ll stand tall on one foot.”*

“Trees sway a little. So will you. That’s totally OK.”

Tree practice (15 min)

- *“Start in mountain. Move your weight onto your **LEFT** foot.”*
- *“Now bend your **RIGHT** knee. Put the **SOLE** of your right foot against the **INSIDE** of your **LEFT** calf. Or below the knee. **NOT** on the knee.”*
- *“Hands at heart — palms together. Or raise them like branches over your head.”*
- *“Look at one spot on the wall and keep looking at it.”*
- *“Breathe like a calm tree.”*
- Hold 15 sec. Switch sides. Hold 15 sec.
- Repeat 3 times each side.

If children wobble: *“Trees sway in the wind! Wobble is what balance feels like when it’s learning.”*

If children fall: laugh together. *“Try again.”*

Reflection (4 min)

- *“Which side was easier?”*
- *“What did your eyes look at?”*

Close (3 min)

Tāḍāsana. Namaste.

Homework

- Stand on one leg at home for 10 seconds. Switch. Repeat. (Brush teeth while doing it!)

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Hold for 30 sec. Try with eyes closed (briefly).
- **Tier down:** Use a wall behind you for support. Or rest the lifted foot on the floor next to the standing foot.

Teacher’s quick notes

- THE knee safety cue is critical. Foot above OR below the knee. NEVER ON the side of the knee.
- Wobble is information. Falling is information. Both are fine. The skill is *trying again*.

Day 3 — Rest Like a Child (balāsana)

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children rest in *balāsana* (child's pose) and notice how it feels in the body.

Materials

- Mats
- Optional: soft blanket for each child

The flow

Settle + opening tādāsana (3 min)

Story (3 min)

*“Today’s pose is **balāsana** — child’s pose. The name literally means ‘child posture.’ It’s the way babies sometimes sleep — curled up, safe, resting.”*

“This is a REST pose. Not a hard pose.”

Child’s pose practice (15 min)

- *“Kneel on your mat. Knees wide apart. Big toes touching.”*
- *“Fold forward. Bring your forehead toward the mat. (If it doesn’t reach — stack your fists and put your head on them.)”*
- *“Arms forward or alongside your body — whichever feels nice.”*
- *“Breathe slowly. This is rest.”*

Hold for 60 seconds. *“Notice your breath.”*

Come up slowly. *“Did anything in your body feel different?”*

Repeat 2 more times (with brief activity between — try a different arm position each time).

Bumblebee preview (5 min)

Sit cross-legged. *“Tomorrow we’ll do a special breath called bumblebee. Just to start: hum like a bee for 3 seconds. Mmmmmm. Did you feel the buzz?”*

Reflection (2 min)

- *“Was child’s pose more like resting or more like working?”*
- *“What did you notice when you sat back up?”*

Close (2 min)

Tādāsana. Namaste.

Homework

- When you feel tired tonight, try child's pose for 1 minute before bed.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Stay in child's pose for 2 minutes. Count your breaths.
- **Tier down:** If knees hurt, put a folded blanket between calves and thighs.

Teacher's quick notes

- Child's pose is restorative. Don't rush.
- If a child's forehead doesn't reach the mat (hip flexibility), stacked fists work fine.
- This is also THE pose to offer when a child is overwhelmed mid-class.

Day 4 — Cat and Cow (mārjārī-bidalāsana)

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children do the cat-cow spine wave with breath co-ordination.

Materials

- Mats
- Pictures of a cat (arched back) and a cow (sagging back)

The flow

Settle + opening tādāsana (3 min)

Story (5 min)

*“Today we have TWO poses that go together — **mārjārī** (cat) and **bidalāsana** (cow). We flow between them like waves.”*

Show pictures: cat with arched back, cow with belly down.

Cat-cow practice (15 min)

- *“Come to your hands and knees on your mat. Hands under shoulders, knees under hips.”*
- *“COW: as you BREATHE IN, drop your belly. Lift your head and tailbone. Look slightly up. Moooo if you like.”*
- *“CAT: as you BREATHE OUT, round your back like a scared cat. Tuck your chin. Meow!”*
- *“COW (inhale). CAT (exhale). COW. CAT.”*

Do 5 slow rounds. Then 5 more, focusing on the breath.

Animal sound bonus (4 min)

“Animal sounds are allowed. Cows say ‘moo.’ Cats say ‘meow.’ Try making the sound on each pose.”

Reflection (3 min)

- “Which felt better — cat or cow?”
- “Did the breath help you move?”

Close (close)

Tāḍāsana. Namaste.

Homework

- 5 cat-cow waves before breakfast. Make the sounds!

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** 10 rounds with deeper breathing.
- **Tier down:** Skip the sounds if shy. Just the movement.

Teacher’s quick notes

- The breath-movement co-ordination is the actual skill. Cue: “breath leads, body follows.”
- Watch wrists — students with wrist issues can do this on forearms.
- Some children will giggle uncontrollably at the animal sounds. Let them — it loosens the body.

Day 5 — Bumblebee Breath (bhrāmarī)

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children practise *bhrāmarī* — the humming breath — and notice the buzzing sensation.

Materials

- Mats
- (No props needed — just bodies and voices)

The flow

Settle + opening tāḍāsana (3 min)

Story (5 min)

*“Today’s special practice is a **breath**, not a pose. It’s called **bhrāmarī** — bumblebee breath. We hum like bees.”*

“Why bees? Because the humming feels like a buzzing in your head — it helps the mind feel quiet.”

Bhrāmarī practice (15 min)

- *“Sit cross-legged. Hands on your knees. Back tall.”*
- *“Take a slow breath IN.”*
- *“As you breathe OUT, hum. ‘Mmmmmmmmm.’ For as long as you can.”*
- *“Then breathe in again. Then hum again.”*

Do 5 rounds together.

Then try ONE round with hands gently covering the ears (just close the ear flaps with fingers).
“Now your hum sounds extra loud — like bees inside your head!”

Do 3 rounds with ears covered.

Reflection (5 min)

- *“How did your head feel after the buzzing?”*
- *“Was it easier or harder than counting breaths?”*

Close (2 min)

Tāḍāsana. Namaste.

Homework

- 5 bumblebee breaths before bedtime tonight. Notice how you feel.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Try 10 rounds. Try a deeper hum.
- **Tier down:** Just normal slow breathing if humming feels uncomfortable.

Teacher’s quick notes

- Asthma alert — if a child has asthma, they do natural breath, no bhrāmarī.
- The “buzzing in the head” is a real sensation — vibration calms the nervous system.
- Some children won’t want to make sound in front of others. They can hum very quietly or just exhale slowly.

Day 6 — Animal Yoga Walk

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children flow through all 5 poses + bhrāmarī as a sequence, animal-style.

Materials

- Mats / open floor

The flow

Settle + opening tādāsana (3 min)

Demo the sequence (5 min)

- “Today we put EVERYTHING together. The Animal Yoga Walk.”
- “Mountain → Flamingo (Tree, both sides) → Sleeping Puppy (Child’s pose) → Cat-Cow waves → Bumblebee → back to Mountain.”

Practice the flow (18 min)

Round 1: very slow, teacher calling each pose.

Mountain – 20 sec
Flamingo (tree pose, right) – 15 sec
Flamingo (tree pose, left) – 15 sec
Sleeping Puppy (child's pose) – 60 sec
Cat-Cow – 5 waves
Bumblebee Breath – 3 rounds
Mountain – 20 sec

Total: about 4 min per round.

Round 2: slightly faster, children leading themselves.

Optional Round 3: a brave child volunteers to call out the sequence.

Reflection (3 min)

- “Which animal felt best in your body?”
- “Which one was hardest?”

Close (1 min)

Tādāsana. Namaste.

Homework

- Practice the full sequence at home — your favourite part TWICE.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add 5 more cat-cow rounds OR 5 more bumblebee breaths.
- **Tier down:** Skip the bumblebee if shy or unwell. Replace with 3 natural breaths in seated.

Teacher’s quick notes

- This is the practice rehearsal for the project. Children should know the FLOW now.

- Day 7 they'll INVENT a pose to add — preview it: “tomorrow, you'll make UP a pose and give it a name!”

Day 7 — Invent a Pose

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Each child invents ONE pose, gives it a name, and tries it.

Materials

- Mats
- Drawing paper + crayons (to draw the pose)

The flow

Settle + opening tādāsana (3 min)

Story (5 min)

“Yoga has thousands of poses, and people are still inventing new ones today. Today YOU invent ONE.”

“It can be inspired by an animal, an object, a feeling — anything. The rules:”

- It must be SAFE (no jumping, no flips, no putting weight on your head).
- It must be HOLDABLE for 10 seconds.
- It must have a NAME (any name — Sanskrit-sounding, animal, made-up).

Invent time (15 min)

- Children sit on their mats and think.
- 5 minutes: try poses quietly.
- 5 minutes: draw your favourite invented pose on paper, with the name above.
- 5 minutes: try the pose 3 times.

Share (5 min)

- 2 brave volunteers demonstrate their invented pose for the class.
- Class tries it together for 5 seconds.

Close (2 min)

Tādāsana. Namaste.

Homework

- Practise your invented pose at home. Get a parent to try it!

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Invent TWO poses. Pick the better one for project day.
- **Tier down:** Modify an existing pose (e.g. tree pose but with hands at a different position).

Teacher's quick notes

- All poses must be vetted for safety. Walk around during invent time.
- Encourage creativity over imitation — but if a child copies tree pose with a different arm position, that's a creative achievement at this age.

Day 8 — Project Day 1

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Each child finalises their invented pose, draws it, and names it.

Materials

- Drawing paper + crayons
- Mats

The flow

Settle + opening tādāsana (3 min)

Project work (20 min)

- Each child decides their final pose name.
- Draws a clear picture of the pose.
- Writes: pose name, what part of the body it stretches/strengthens.
- Practises the pose 3 times.

Buddy check (5 min)

- Find a partner. Show your pose. Partner tries it. Partner says ONE thing that worked.

Close (2 min)

Tādāsana. Namaste.

Homework

- Practise teaching your pose to a parent at home. Get them to try it!

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Write 3 sentences of instructions for your pose.

- **Tier down:** Just a drawing + the name is enough.

Teacher's quick notes

- Confirm pose safety for every child. Redirect any unsafe poses now.
- Some children will struggle to invent — let them adapt an existing pose with a new name.

Day 9 — Project Day 2 (Practise Teaching)

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Each child rehearses their 1-minute pose teaching.

Materials

- Mats
- Pose drawings

The flow

Settle + opening tādāsana (3 min)

Rehearsal (20 min)

- Children pair up.
- Each child teaches their pose to their partner for 1 minute:
 - Name the pose.
 - Show the pose.
 - Give 2 cues (where to put hands, where to look, etc.).
 - Hold for 10 seconds.
- Swap.
- Then change partners and rehearse again. (Aim for 3 different partners.)

Wrap (5 min)

- 2 children share: “*What was the best feedback I got?*”

Close (2 min)

Tādāsana. Namaste.

Homework

- Practise your teaching ONE more time at home. Tomorrow is the showcase!

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Teach without your drawing — from memory.
- **Tier down:** Read off your drawing if you need to.

Teacher's quick notes

- The 1-minute teach is the actual project. Practice the timing.
- If a child is too shy to teach alone, they can co-teach with a buddy.

Day 10 — Pose Showcase

Module: Yoga (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min (extend if needed)

Goal

Every child teaches their invented pose to the class for 1 minute.

Materials

- Mats laid out
- Stickers
- A bell / chime to mark 1 minute

The flow

Settle + opening tādāsana (3 min)

The biggest, most attentive mountain of the module.

Pose Showcase (24 min)

- 1 child at a time.
- 1 minute each (chime when time's up).
- Each child:
 1. Says their pose name.
 2. Shows the pose.
 3. Class tries it for 10 seconds.
- Class claps. Sticker.

With ~24 children in 24 minutes, plan tight pacing OR extend into a buffer period.

Closing ceremony (3 min)

- Whole class in tādāsana.
- Teacher: *"You've all learned 5 poses, 1 breath, and INVENTED your own. You're yoga teachers now."*
- Final namaste.

Homework

- None. Module complete.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** A child who finishes can lead the class in mountain pose during the closing.
- **Tier down:** Co-teach with a buddy if too shy alone.

Teacher's quick notes

- This is celebration day. Every pose is a success.
- Take photos of every pose; send to parents.
- Mark the chime gently — children sometimes need 90 seconds, that's fine.